the Registrar of Unincorporated Small Businesses, under the Small Enterprises Act. Just like all incorporated businesses, small or large, have a unique business identity under the Companies Act, all unincorporated small businesses should have a unique business identity under the MSME Act.

The government and the Registrar of Unincorporated Small Businesses should undertake a mission to register every small business of the country, obtain critical entity-related information for all the small businesses in the country and assign a Unique Small Business ID (USBID) to every small business. Keeping in mind the smallness of resources of small businesses, this system of collection of information should be digital and require only a minimum set of critical business information to be obtained, preferably once a year.

As unincorporated small businesses are organized on the unlimited liability of their owners, it therefore becomes necessary to register the details of every owner of such businesses, including their individual Aadhaar numbers. The USBID should have all its owners mapped to it.

The Registrar of Unincorporated Small Businesses can be organized from the bottom up; from the municipality/panchayat to the tehsil, district and state, and finally combined in a single national digital register. In the present digital age, it should be quite easy and costless to construct a register of 7 crore small businesses in a decentralized-centralized mode.

Mapping All Services to the USBID

The USBID should be made mandatory to transact with every public and financial entity. Banks should consider providing credit to the small businesses recording their USBID and link all their loans and deposit accounts with it.

All other authorities that need an identity distinguisher for small businesses can create and link their identifier with the USBID of a small business. Banks can link their account number with the USBID. Taxation